



HOIETFESCHT

28. HOIET, 2018/JULY 28, 2018

ROBERT LUSCH (WITH THANKS TO BRIAN WEIS FOR CONTENT)
REV-D1

Honoring: Njord, Nerthus, Erda, Frey, Freya, Grain Wane and Spirits (Lady of the Wheat, Lord of the Rye, etc.).

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Ingwaz/Engel , Jera/Yaahr , Wunjo/Winsch , Laguz/Loch 

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Hammer un Sichel, heilicht daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe,
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeit un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei Fraa Holle, Weisskeppiche Fraa, un Ewiche Yeeger un fer es Volk zu erneire
Bei der Waahr fer die Sippschaft zu zunemme
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Hammer un Sichel, heilicht daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer es Hoietfescht zu feiere.

Heel zu de Ziewe!

Heel zu de Wichde!

Heel zum Land!

Heel zu der Gmeeschaft!

Today, we celebrate

- *Hoietfescht, the Urglaawe "Haymaking" Festival and the creation of food to last cattle and other animals through the coming winter.*
- *Hlafmaest, a modern Anglo-Saxon reconstruction of Loaf Feed or Loaf Feast, re-Heathenizing the old Christian holiday of Loaf Mass.*
- *Freyfaxi (or "Frey's Mane") a First Harvest festival for our Asatru brethren*

For our ancestors,

The start of the grain harvest was a time for celebration.

This was the first time in months that they could

Bake new bread, or brew new ale.

They marked this time with a feast of the first fruits.

*Our society does not place nearly the emphasis
on harvest times that our ancestors did.*

Because we have 7/11, Burger King, and frozen entrees

We don't know what it is like to truly wait for food.

Can you imagine what our ancestors would think of the meat department in Wegman's?

At first, they might revel in what would surely seem a miracle

Something that, to them, would be akin to the refilling boards in the halls of Valhalla.

But after the shock wore off, they would likely see us as spoiled, and they would likely be right.

Because our ancestors had a much more visceral experience

of where their food came from, of the effort expended for it,

and we would do well to be mindful of it.

In the Urglaawe tradition, this is the celebration of life.

A time to revel in the rewards of our hard work

and to ponder the wonders of the universe.

It is a time of joy, community, color, and sharing.

We also celebrate the harvesting of the hay that feeds the animals who feed us

and who help to spread the seeds of plants.

*This is an aspect of the Zusaagpflicht: to provide for and to nourish the world around us,
so that we may benefit in return.*

As a Scandinavian harvest celebration, this is a time of rejoicing

and a time for reaping what one has sown.

In both cases, this is a time to celebrate the rewards of hard work.

And while we may not be working the land,

Each one of us had engaged in work that taxes body or mind

*And so we should feel pride in what we have wrought
In service of our homes, families, and communities.*

*So with all this in mind, let us invoke our divine guests
and join together in celebration of life and the folk.
Thus we shall demonstrate
our appreciation of the gifts
of the land spirits and deities
in the company of community.*

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

*Njord, broad and expansive.
Lord over the Surface of the Sea
Giver of wealth and good fortune!
Your bounty extends to even we who roam the land.*

*Nerthus, Earth Mother, womb of the world.
Sister-Wife of Njord, Mother of the divine twins*

*Erda, the Earth Mother as known in our Deutsch tongue
Wife of the Butzemann
Giver of Life to all*

*Freya, Lady of love, beauty, and fertility
Sister-Lover to Frey
Goddess of the Necklace
You who possess your share of the slain and hold secret knowledge*

*Frey, Njord's son, golden-haired boar-rider
Green lord of the woods and lover of life
You are a Giver of Peace, but willing to hand out war in kind.
We hail you as God of the Fertile Season and of the Folk!*

*Grain Deities and Spirits!
Today we break bread from the bounty You have provided to us.
We are grateful for the bounty on our table
and to be able to pass that bounty on to the animals in our care.*

*Grace us, now, with your presence among us.
We bid you welcome, not that we are ever truly parted from you
For you are far larger than the universe could ever hope to contain,
And yet you can also dwell within the smallest of particles.*

We bid you welcome now because we are focused in our remembrance

Join us as our kin and companions

Be our guest that we might show you honor and declare our love

Es Opfer un Die Eed Offerings and Oaths

Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle

Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.

If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.

If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - The Hallowing of the Offerings

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns

Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder

From the gods to the Earth to us

From us to the Earth to the gods

'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk

Heele!

A gift for a gift.

Hail!

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Zu de Wichde - To the Wights

DISCUSSION TOPICS

Welcome to Distelfink's Hoietfescht celebration, which is also serving as our public ritual as a Troth kindred! Thank you for joining us today. Typically, this is an event that has several participants who are new to Heathenry.

There are enough commonalities among most denominations of Heathenry that there is little discord, and the differences serve as a reflection of the individual tribal identities that our forebears' had. Heathenry was never monolithic. It was, instead, the result of an organic evolution of related or associated tribes' shared history combined with their unique experiences and expressed through their individual cultural lenses. There is no central authority that can define orthopraxy or orthodoxy for other groups or individuals. This decentralization is one of Heathenry's greatest gifts, but it can also pose some challenges.

I had considered writing about some of these challenges, but the resulting document would exceed the scope of this ceremony's discussion item. If you are curious about this topic, please feel free to contact me by email at schreiwier@urglaawe.org or on Facebook at <http://www.facebook.com/robert.schreiwier>.

So.. What is this observance about?

On the mundane level, Hoietfescht is an expression of the celebration of the first harvest and the resulting haymaking. On a more spiritual level, the concept of the gifts of fertile land and rewards for hard work expand to include reaping the bounty of all aspects of life, whether by accepting universal gifts or by using your talents and mental faculties to achieve goals and success. This means that today we will celebrate anything that benefits us in our lives, including the things we plant and nurture.

Obviously, we plant and nurture many of the crops that we depend on for sustenance, but we also plant and nurture many other things from which we reap rewards. So today we also celebrate friendships, loving relationships, and communities. We rejoice at the results of our creative efforts and educational pursuits. If we made reasonable New Year's resolutions and stuck to them, we are likely achieving some of our goals. The metaphor of the harvest extends to so many aspects of our lives that we often overlook, and today is a most auspicious time to take inventory of the blessings in your life.

As you will undoubtedly discover throughout the course of the discussions and the ritual, there are additional concepts woven into the observance of this time. Indeed, each of us may have unique insights based on our own experiences and proclivities, but I hope that this article has provided you with a basic understanding of the purpose of our gathering today.

Topics particular to 2017:

Nerthus and Erda: Erda is a goddess known to the Deitsch and very likely is Nerthus known within the context of our own culture. It is said that Nerthus finds iron offensive, so we remove all items made of iron from the ritual area during Sege. Interestingly, there is a ban in Deitsch Hexerei against the use of iron on Vervain, which is a plant associated with Erda. Today we are honoring Nerthus and Erda as individual goddesses, but our research is pointing us more and more toward a consensus that They are the same goddess. In addition to Vervain, strawberries are also sacred to Erda.

Grain Deities and Spirits: This is a long overdue aspect from our folklore and from the Folklore Research Project. There are deities and/or spirits associated with many of the grains, particularly Wheat (Weeze, goddess), Spelt (Schpels, god), Rye (Kann, god), Flax (Flax, spirit; also associated with Holle and Berchta), Barley (Gaerscht, god), Oat (Hawwer, spirit) and more. There are stories that relate to these entities that will hopefully be ready to be published before Hoietfescht next year.

Traditionally within the Deitsch culture, it was customary to have minor festivals for many of the crop harvests. This is echoed today in strawberry festivals, cherry blossom festivals, etc.

The Troth

The Troth is a large, international Heathen organization, and Distelfink is a Troth-affiliated kindred. Thus, you will see some Troth items present: The Troth's horn, The Troth's oath ring, and a few other items.

We will discuss some of the ongoing projects of The Troth as well as the emerging initiatives.

Lore: Ynglinga Saga

Heimskringla

from the Online Medieval and Classical Library

OF NJORD. Njord of Noatun was then the sole sovereign of the Swedes; and he continued the sacrifices, and was called the drot or sovereign by the Swedes, and he received scatt and gifts from them. In his days were peace and plenty, and such good years, in all respects, that the Swedes believed Njord ruled over the growth of seasons and the prosperity of the people. In his time all the diar or gods died, and blood-sacrifices were made for them. Njord died on a bed of sickness, and before he died made himself be marked for Odin with the spear-point. The Swedes burned him, and all wept over his grave-mound.

FREY'S DEATH. Frey took the kingdom after Njord, and was called drot by the Swedes, and they paid taxes to him. He was, like his father, fortunate in friends and in good seasons. Frey built a great temple at Upsal, made it his chief seat, and gave it all his taxes, his land, and goods. Then began the Upsal domains, which have remained ever since. Then began in his days the Frode- peace; and then there were good seasons, in all the land, which the Swedes ascribed to Frey, so that he was more worshipped than the other gods, as the people became much richer in his days by reason of the peace and good seasons. His wife was called Gerd, daughter of Gymis, and their son was called Fjolne. Frey was called by another name, Yngve; and this name Yngve was considered long after in his race as a name of honour, so that his descendants have since been called Ynglinger. Frey fell into a sickness; and as his illness took the upper hand, his men took the plan of letting few approach him. In the meantime they raised a great mound, in which they placed a door with three holes in it. Now when Frey died they bore him secretly into the mound, but told the Swedes he was alive; and they kept watch over him for three years. They brought all the taxes into the mound, and through the one hole they put in the gold, through the other the silver, and through the third the copper money that was paid. Peace and good seasons continued.

Deitsch Lore

OF THE HOIET: "die Hoiet" literally means "the hay time" (Hoi+Zeit) and falls roughly from mid-July to mid-August. In the Urglaawe usage of Deitsch, it is also the name of the month of July. This is a celebration of bounty and of harvest, making it very much a harvest celebration that honors the Wane. There are also numerous Deitsch and German myths of "fairies" (Maerrich (sing.)/Maerriche (pl.) or Fae (sing.)/Faee (pl.)) aiding in the haymaking. Some of the myths indicate that the fairies are in the service of the deities and/or of the ancestors in order to keep the human life stream strong and evolving. One tale tells of a farmer who loses both his parents around the time of the French and Indian War. Prior to her passing, his ailing mother is offered a sizeable sum of money to sell a parcel of wooded land to a company that was financing the British war effort. His mother was tempted to take the offer, but she was awoken one night by the hooting of an owl, and then she heard the wailing of the trees at their potential death. The mother continued to dither over whether to leave her son the land, which he cannot farm alone, or to provide him with enough money to live on for several years. She consults with a Hex about her quandary, and the Hex advises her to employ fairies to aid in the farm work of collecting hay to feed the cattle. In exchange, the fairies were to get all of the cream from the strongest cow and the wooded land would remain intact. The mother takes the advice of the Hex, and, after the Hex leaves, she passes away. The story ensues about her son finding the work done throughout the Hoiet, and he is able to sell large volumes of hay to the militias.

The son is unaware of how the work is being done, and he also is not aware of the agreement regarding the cow's cream, and the milk with the cream, is stolen in a Shawnee raid. His fortunes suddenly change, and he finds his fields untended, and he quickly depletes his money supply. Seeking understanding, he calls to his mother's spirit for help. A swallowtail butterfly appears to him and beckons to him with its tail, leading him to the cottage of the Hex, who provides him with the details of the agreement. The son immediately asks for help from the Hex in how to repair the relations with the fairies, and he is given appropriate information. He follows through, and, as is the case in many tales, he lives happily ever after.

The same, though, cannot be said for the Shawnee who stole the milk with the cream. The cream became hexed and the fairies warred against those who stole it. Some intimations in the varieties of this myth lead one to conclude that their fortunes went badly, and they were ultimately forced not only to make peace with those whom they have raided but also to serve the British crown against the French.

Snorri Sturluson on Njörðr:

'The third Ás is the one called Njord. He lives in heaven in a place called Noatun. He rules over the motion of wind and moderates sea and fire. It is to him one must pray for voyages and fishing. He is so rich and wealthy that he can grant wealth of lands or possessions to those that pray to him for this.'

Edda, Snorri Sturluson (Antony Faulkes - trans)

The Lay of Beli

Thorskegga Thorn

[Frey has come to the aid of his people and exchanged "pleasantries" with the giant Beli]

'You insult me ?' The giant shouted.
 'You who dabble in cowards magic ?
 Iron against iron that is honour
 to settle disputes between etins'.
 'This is honour ?' cried Freyr enraged
 spreading arms wide across ruined lands.
 'These farmers used iron for ploughshares'
 these honest folk who called Freyr "friend".
 Clear the fields repay their loss
 swear never to leave Etin Land again.
 If you refuse then you will die,
 Freyr has no mercy for evil etins'.
 Freyr stepped forward offering truce.
 Beli laughed loud and swung his sword
 deep bit the blade into the ground
 tearing the turf by Freyr's feet.
 Freyja's brother pulled from his cloak
 a wand of antler. Freyr spoke Van spells
 the Harvest-god's wise words of power.
 The wand pointing at Beli's breast.
 Fire leapt from Freyr, scorching lightning.
 Loud howled Beli and fell dying
 Trees were broken by the giant's body.
 When he fell the earth was shaken.

Skirnir called the folk from hiding,
 fearful and burnt, ragged and hungry,
 a woman wept for her lost love.
 The destroyed farms meant starvation.
 Beli's Bane sang an incantation
 green shoots grew from blackened soil.
 The people cheered the Glorious Van
 as they beheld the golden corn.
 Freyr took up the etin sword
 a dozen yards of heavy iron.
 By his strong hands the blade was broken.
 Njord's son called the people round.
 'Your cattle are slain your stores destroyed.
 Melt down this sword for iron ingots.
 Use their value to buy more cattle
 and food to see your harvest home'.
 Freyr and Skirnir mounted the wain.
 The folk followed with joyful hearts.
 People praised victorious van god.
 Long they'd remember Njord's bounteous son.
 Freyr called spirits of the fallen
 to join him on his journey home.
 Beli's victims followed the van god
 across the heavens to the Folk Field.

"To Frey"

from Pagan Book of Hours

*Hail Frey, Lord of the fields!
Lord of the Vanir,
Golden of hair as the fields of wheat,
Bringing riches of heart and hearth
To noble and common folk alike,
We hail you with the corn that springs forth
And falls again to nourish us.
We hail you, mighty boar in flight,
Lord of the phallus that gives life,
Lord of Love that is bound to land,
Love that is bound with commitment,
Love that does not come easily,
As one must toil for the harvest.
Teach us that love is worth working for,
And that work is worth loving,
And that neither lives long without the other.
Lord Frey, Corn God,
Husband of Gerda the etin-bride,
You who can warm the cold heart,
Warrior without a weapon
Who gave your sword for love,
You who make the grain spring forth,
Show us faith in every springtime.*

"To Njord"

from Pagan Book of Hours

*Hail, Njord, Lord of the Surface of the Sea!
Hail, Sailor's Watcher,
Lord of Ships upon the waters.
Blessed you are in the prow,
Where you lead us forward to our goals.
Blessed you are in the stern,
Where you guard our wake
From the monsters of the Deep.
Blessed you are on the port,
Where your keen eyes search the horizon.
Blessed you are on the starboard,
Where you guide us by the stars.
Blessed you are on the high mast,
Where you stand tall with far vision.
Blessed you are in the sails,
Which you fill with billowing winds.
Blessed you are at the rudder,
Where you skillfully outrun all storms.
Blessed you are at the nets,
Where the fish come by the thousands into our hands.
Blessed you are belowdecks,
Where you rock us gently to sleep
On the waves of certainty,
Knowing that the farthest shore
Will soon be under our feet.
Hail Njord, Lord of Ships,
Guide our souls safely across the waters.*

All Worship is Remembrance

by Dave Haxton

*All worship is remembrance.
We remember the gods and goddesses.
We remember our ancestors.
We remember word and deed.
We remember stock and stone.
The Well is our remembering.
Our memories are in the Well.
Our memories are the Well.
The Tree is nourished by the Well.
We grow and thrive within the Tree.
We are fed by our memories.
We are sustained by our worship.
All worship is remembrance.*

En Hoietlied

En netter Mann
Schneidet die Weez'
En netti Fraa
Schneidet der Flax
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Der nett yung Mann
Sammelt die Weez'
Die nett yung Fraa
Sammelt der Flax
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Der nett yung Mann
Schpraecht d'Weeze aus
Die nett yung Fraa
Schpraecht der Flax aus
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Der nett yung Mann
Wennt d'Weeze uff
Die nett yung Fraa
Wennt der Flax uff
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Der nett yung Mann
Rechert die Weez'
Die nett yung Fraa
rechert der Flax
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Der nett yung Mann
Binnt d'Weeze uff
Die nett yung Fraa
Binnt der Flax uff
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Der nett yung Mann
Legt d'Weeze ei
Die nett yung Fraa
Legt der Flax ei
Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

Hoiet! Hoiet!
Dicke dicke duh raa ie

A Hay-making Work Song

A nice man
mows the wheat
A nice woman
mows the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee

The nice young man
collects the wheat
The nice young woman
collects the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee

The nice young man
spreads out the wheat
The nice young woman
spreads out the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee

The nice young man
teds the wheat
The nice young woman
teds the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee

The nice young man
rakes the wheat
The nice young woman
rakes the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!

Dicke dicke do raw ee

The nice young man
bales the wheat
The nice young woman
bales the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee

The nice young man
Stores up the wheat
The nice young woman
Stores up the flax
Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee

Haymaking! Haymaking!
Dicke dicke do raw ee